

PAULA Side

Mo has been stranded in Mexico for six months, and is attempting to return to America. Paula is the most recent US Embassy Staffer out of a long line of people he's looked to for help.

START

INT. EMBASSY - USCIS FIELD OFFICE - DAY

We join Mo mid-meeting with another staffer -- PAULA, a Michelle Wolf-type.

PAULA

Wait -- you don't have a passport?

Mo works to stay cool despite living in *Groundhog's Day*.

MO

My family's from Palestine.

PAULA

Okay...

MO

Palestine is stateless, stateless people don't have passports, therefore -- I don't have a passport.

(sensing futility)

Which is why I'm here seeking a laissez-passer.

PAULA

Right... Unfortunately, I'm not really the person you should be --

continue

Mo's gazes at a portrait of AMBASSADOR FRANCESCO.

MO

I'm sorry to interrupt, but --
could the Ambassador authorize one?

PAULA

A laissez-passer? Yeah. Sure.

MO

Is there any way that I could speak
with him directly?

PAULA

You want a meeting with --
Ambassador Francesco?

Mo leans in, pleading:

MO

I know it's a long shot. But I've
already met a small village of
people who can't actually **do**
anything for me, and I'm starting
to panic a little 'cos I have an
asylum hearing in Houston next week
I've waited basically my whole life
for, and I just found out that my
mom had heatstroke, and if I could
just speak one-on-one with him, I
know I could--

Paula stops him, picks up her office phone, starts dialing.

PAULA

Say no more.

MO

Really?

PAULA

(phone to ear)

What's best for you? Mornings or
evening? I know he plays squash in
the afternoons, but--

MO

Any time. Any time at all. Whatever
works. Thank you so much, this is --

PAULA

Would you like a private audience
with Rihanna as well? 'cos I can
get her avails too...

continue

MO
...Okay. I see what you're doing.

PAULA
Oh you do? You see what I'm doing?
She hangs up the phone, smirks. Mo deflates.

MO
Yeah. Good one. Thank you.

END